



Samsung A8s

The Samsung A8s was launched sporting an Infinity-O display, three rear cameras and a rear fingerprint sensor. <https://digit.in/jan19-23>



iPhones banned in China

China has banned several models of the iPhone including the iPhone X over patent infringement against Qualcomm. <https://digit.in/jan19-24>



What is this 5G you speak of?

The 5G hype train is already off the rails but Agent001 is not going to be an early adopter, this time.

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veryone's been harping about 5G of late. We only saw presentations from technology compa-

nies up until early 2018 but as MWC 2018 came into view, we saw some of the very same companies demonstrate their enterprise offerings. As the year progressed, we saw the likes of Qualcomm, Intel, Motorola and Ericsson showcase their 5G products as well. It was only in July 2018 that the actual 5G standard was finalised by the folks over at 3GPP. All products featuring 5G till that time were based on the draft standards i.e. milestones in the standardisation process but not the actual standard. That didn't stop people from lusting after the new G. Folks have already started looking to get 5G on their personal devices and homes. While this is not an unreasonable request, you really need to understand if 5G will really make a difference with such applications and use cases.

With each revision to the cellular networking standard the manufacturers make small but notable changes and test out the entire setup to see how it fares. The final 5G standard is poised to bring in quite a few notable improvements. Depending on which

band it is set to, a 5G device will be able to handle up to 20 Gbits/s, that's like getting a super fast fibre line, except, it's wireless. Then there's the reduced power consumption and the reduced latencies as well. Aside from these two key parameters, 5G radios will also be able to talk to a lot more devices at the same time which makes it excellent for deployment in high-density areas. These put together make 5G the



messiah of high-bandwidth applications such as mass surveillance, autonomous vehicles, fleet management, IoT, smart cities, high-res and high-quality multimedia transmission, etc. One can see why 5G would really turn things around.

Of course, we'd like to have all of the aforementioned niceties, but before we delve into that, how about we explore whether we're making good use of the existing technologies' full potential.

I'm talking about us as a country and as a people. None of the existing telecom players in the country have a good 4G network. They all claim to have the best but that's all on a relative scale and being better than crap isn't exactly a great achievement to boast. If you've been to any of the Tier 1 cities then you know how bad the situation is. You'll experience excellent connectivity at few hotspots peppered across the city but most of the city gets poor coverage. This was when the networks were primarily 3G, the move to 4G has only made things worse as the higher bandwidth is only afforded on higher frequency bands. The very same bands which have poor penetration. Now apply the same train of thought to

when 5G becomes a reality. If you're on the sub-6 GHz band, things will be slightly worse than it is right now and if you happen to be on the mmwave band, then I'd rather not get into how bad it'll be. The only way to overcome this problem of poor penetration is by increasing the density of signal towers and that's not going to be good for living beings. Don't take my word for it, see what more than 180 scientists and doctors from 36 countries had to say about the matter when they appealed to the EU regarding rolling out 5G in the European Union. One of the